

Kate Nussenbaum

Boston University
Department of Psychological & Brain Sciences
111 Cummington Mall, Room 208
Boston, MA 02215

Email: katenuss@bu.edu
Web: <https://bucoldlab.org/>

Academic Positions

7/1/2025 - : **Assistant Professor**, Psychological and Brain Sciences, Boston University

Education and Training

2023 - 2025: **C.V. Starr Fellow**, Princeton Neuroscience Institute
Advisor: Nathaniel Daw

2017 - 2023: **Ph.D.**, Psychology, New York University
Advisor: Catherine Hartley

2015 - 2017: **M.Sc. by Research**, Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford
Advisors: Kia Nobre, Gaia Scerif

2011 - 2015: **Sc.B.**, Cognitive Neuroscience; Science & Society, Brown University
Advisor: Dima Amso

Research Funding

Active

2027 - 2029: **BBRF Young Investigator Grant**
Charting the neurodevelopmental emergence of upward counterfactual simulation
Role: PI
Amount: \$70,000

2026 - 2028: **Jacobs CIFAR Research Fellowship**
Understanding the relation between environmental predictability and structure-learning across development
Role: PI
Amount: \$183,000

Completed

2023 - 2025: **C.V. Starr Foundation Postdoctoral Fellowship**
Role: PI
Amount: \$164,000

2022 - 2023: **NIMH F31 Ruth L. Kirschstein National Research Service Award**
The development of adaptive specificity in learning and memory
Role: PI
Amount: \$41,115

2018 - 2021: U.S. Department of Defense NDSEG Fellowship*Neurocognitive mechanisms underlying optimal learning in dynamic environments*

Role: PI

Amount: \$118,000 + 3 years tuition

Awards and Honors

- 2027: BBRF Young Investigator Award
- 2026: Rising Star Award, *Association for Psychological Science*
- 2026: Jacobs CIFAR Research Fellowship
- 2024: Fryer Award for Best Doctoral Thesis, *NYU Department of Psychology*
- 2021: Dissertation Research Award, *American Psychological Association*
- 2021: Martin Braine Fellowship, *NYU Department of Psychology*
- 2020: NYU Katzell Summer Fellowship, *NYU Department of Psychology*
- 2018, 2019: Dean's Travel Grant, *NYU Graduate School of Arts and Sciences*
- 2017: Travel Award, *Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*
- 2017: Engberg Award for an Outstanding Entering Graduate Student, *NYU Department of Psychology*
- 2017: Grindley Grant, *Experimental Psychology Society*
- 2016, 2017: Murray Speight Research Grant, *Rhodes Trust*
- 2016: Editor's Choice Award (best 2016 paper), *Journal of Cognition and Development*
- 2015 - 2017: Rhodes Scholarship
- 2015: Marshall Scholarship (declined)
- 2015: Whalen Award for Undergraduate Research in Neuroscience, *Brown University*
- 2015: Research at Brown Travel Award, *Brown University*
- 2015: Sigma Xi
- 2014: Phi Beta Kappa (*early election as a junior*)
- 2014: Undergraduate Teaching and Research Award, *Brown University*
- 2013 - 2014: Teaching-Research-Impact Lab Student Fellowship, *Brown University*
- 2013: Solsbery Summer Research Fellowship, *Brown University*
- 2011: United States Presidential Scholar (*1 of 2 from Massachusetts*)
- 2011: National Merit Scholarship

Publications

Trainees working under my mentorship are underlined. The * denotes equal author contribution.

Journal Articles

20. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Kahn, A.E., Zhang, A., Daw, N.D., & Hartley, C.A. (2026). Developmental change in structure learning reflects a shift from recency-based to relational prediction. *Developmental Science*.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)

19. Zhang, A., Kahn, A.E., Daw, N.D., **Nussenbaum, K.***, & Hartley, C.A.* (2026). Children leverage predictive representations for flexible, value-guided choice. *Cognition*, 266, 106340.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
18. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2025). Reinforcement learning increasingly shapes memory specificity from childhood to adulthood. *Nature Communications*, 16, 4074.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
17. Jach, H.K., Cools, R., Frisvold, A., Grubb, M., Hartley, C.A., Hartman, J., Hunter, L., Jia, R., de Lange, F., Larisch, R., Lavelle-Hill, R., Levy, I., Li, Y., van Lieshout, L., **Nussenbaum, K.**, Ravaioli, S., Wilson, R., Woodford, M., Murayama, K., & Gottlieb, J. (2024). Individual differences in information demand have a low dimensional structure predicted by some curiosity personality traits. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121(45), e2415236121.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
16. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Meta-learned models as tools to test theories of cognitive development. (Commentary on Binz et al). *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 47, e157.
[\[link\]](#)
15. **Nussenbaum, K.***, Katzman, P.L.*, Lu, H., Zorowitz, S., & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Sensitivity to the instrumental value of choice increases across development. *Psychological Science*, 35(8), 933-947.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
14. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Understanding the development of reward learning through the lens of meta-learning. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 3, 424-438.
[\[link\]](#)
13. **Nussenbaum, K.***, Martin, R.E.*, Maulhardt, S., Yang, J., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Bhatt, N.S., Scheuplein, M., Rosenbaum, G.M., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Novelty and uncertainty differentially drive exploration across development. *eLife*, 12, e84260.
[\[pdf\]](#)[\[data & code\]](#)
12. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Velez, J.A., Washington, B.T., Hamling, H.E., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Flexibility in valenced reinforcement learning computations across development. *Child Development*, 93, 1601-1615.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
11. Hartley, C.A., **Nussenbaum, K.**, & Cohen, A.O. (2021). Interactive development of adaptive learning and memory. *Annual Review of Developmental Psychology*, 3, 59 - 85.
[\[pdf\]](#)
10. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2021). Developmental change in prefrontal cortex recruitment supports the emergence of value-guided memory. *eLife*, 10, e69796.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
9. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Scheuplein, M., Phaneuf, C.V., Evans, M.D., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Moving developmental research online: comparing in-lab and web-based studies of model-based reinforcement learning. *Collabra: Psychology*, 6(1), 1-18.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)

8. Cohen, A.O.*, **Nussenbaum, K.***, Dorfman, H.M., Gershman, S.J., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). The rational use of causal inference to guide reinforcement learning strengthens with age. *npj Science of Learning*, 5(16), 1-9.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
7. **Nussenbaum, K.***, Cohen, A.O.*, Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D.J., Gureckis, T.M., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Causal information-seeking strategies change across childhood and adolescence. *Cognitive Science*, 44(8), e12888.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
6. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Prentis, E., & Hartley C.A. (2020). Memory's reflection of learned information value increases across development. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 149(10), 1919-1934.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
5. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Reinforcement learning across development: What insights can we draw from a decade of research? *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, 40, 100733.
[\[pdf\]](#)
4. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Scerif, G.*, & Nobre, A.C.* (2019). Differential effects of salient visual events on memory-guided attention in adults and children. *Child Development*, 90(4), 1369-1388.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)
3. **Nussenbaum, K.**, Amso, D., & Markant, J. (2017). When increasing distraction helps learning: Distractor number and content interact in their effects on memory. *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*, 79(8), 2606-2619.
[\[pdf\]](#) [\[data\]](#)
2. Markant, J., Ackerman, L., **Nussenbaum, K.**, & Amso, D. (2016). Selective attention neutralizes the adverse effects of low socioeconomic status on memory in 9-month-old infants. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, 18, 26-33.
[\[pdf\]](#)
1. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Amso, D. (2016). An attentional Goldilocks effect: An optimal amount of social interactivity promotes word learning from video. *Journal of Cognition and Development*, 17(1), 30-40.
[\[pdf\]](#)

Received Editor's Choice Award for journal's best 2016 article.

Submitted Manuscripts

1. Binz et al. (under review). Post-training makes large language models less human-like. [\[preprint\]](#)
2. **Nussenbaum, K.***, Hamling, H.E.*, Zhu, H., Kerbl, L., Washington, L., & Hartley, C.A. (in revision, *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*). Heightened adaptability to environmental volatility in adolescence. [\[preprint\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

6. **Nussenbaum, K.**, & Daw, N. (2024). Individual differences in strategic exploration may reflect rational consideration of learning. *Cognitive Computational Neuroscience*, Boston, MA. [\[pdf\]](#)

5. Lu, H.*, Katzman, P.*, **Nussenbaum, K.**, & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Sensitivity to the instrumental value of agency increases across development. *Cognitive Computational Neuroscience*, Oxford, UK. [\[pdf\]](#)
4. Zhang, A., **Nussenbaum, K.**, & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Development of non-local learning. *Cognitive Computational Neuroscience*, Oxford, UK. [\[pdf\]](#)
3. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Reinforcement learning influences memory specificity across development. *Cognitive Computational Neuroscience*, Oxford, UK. [\[pdf\]](#)
2. **Nussenbaum, K.** & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Prefrontal-striatal circuitry supports adaptive memory prioritization across development. In: *Proceedings of the 42nd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. [\[pdf\]](#)
1. **Nussenbaum, K.***, Cohen, A.O.*, Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D., Gureckis, T.M., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Causal intervention strategies change across adolescence. In: *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[data & code\]](#)

Invited Talks

2027: (forthcoming) Reinforcement Learning & Decision Making, Paris, France
 2026: (forthcoming) Brown University, Social Cognitive Seminar Series
 2026: Duke University, Center for Cognitive Neuroscience
 2026: Cognitive Development Society Workshop on Motivation, Montreal, Canada
 2026: COSYNE Workshop on Algorithms for Learning from Scratch, Cascais, Portugal
 2026: Ghent University, Department of Experimental Psychology
 2026: University of New Hampshire, Department of Psychology
 2026: Boston University, Brain, Behavior, & Cognition Colloquium
 2026: Stanford University, Causality in Cognition Lab Meeting (PI: Tobias Gerstenberg)
 2025: Curiosity, Information Seeking, & Exploration Conference, Providence, RI
 2024: NYU, ConCats Seminar
 2024: Boston University, Developmental Science Colloquium
 2024: University of Birmingham, Mega-Decision Lab Meeting (virtual)
 2024: Princeton University, PDP Seminar
 2024: Boston University, Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences
 2023: UNC Chapel Hill, Human Neuroimaging Group (virtual)
 2023: UT Dallas, Aging Well Lab (PI: Kendra Seaman) (virtual)
 2023: Dartmouth College, Program in Cognitive Science
 2021: Flux Congress Computational Modeling in Development Workshop (virtual)
 2021: NYU, Department of Psychology
 2020: University College London, Affective Brain Lab (PI: Tali Sharot) (virtual)
 2020: Columbia University, Developmental Affective Neuroscience Lab (PI: Nim Tottenham) (virtual)
 2020: University of Oregon, Developing Brains in Context Lab (PI: Kate Mills) (virtual)
 2020: Tulane University, Learning and Brain Development Lab (PI: Julie Markant) (virtual)
 2019: NYU, ConCats Seminar

Conference Presentations

Talks

Nussenbaum, K. & Daw, N.D. (2025). Good and consequential counterfactual outcomes are prioritized during learning. Talk at the conference on Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Reinforcement learning increasingly shapes memory specificity from childhood to adulthood. Talk at the Manhattan Area Memory Meeting, New Haven, CT.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Reinforcement learning increasingly shapes memory specificity from childhood to adulthood. Talk at the Context and Episodic Memory Symposium, Philadelphia, PA.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Reinforcement learning increasingly shapes memory specificity from childhood to adulthood. Symposium talk at the Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, San Francisco, CA. ***Chair of symposium on 'Dynamic interactions between learning and memory across the lifespan.'***

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Maulhardt, S., Yang, J., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Bhatt, N.S., Scheuplein, M., Rosenbaum, G.M., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Novelty and uncertainty differentially drive exploration across development. Lightning talk at the International Conference on Learning and Memory, Huntington Beach, CA.

Nussenbaum, K., Hamling, H.E., Zhu, H., Kerbl, L., Washington, B.T., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Sensitivity to environmental volatility across development: Evidence from reinforcement learning and pupillometry. Symposium talk at the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Maulhardt, S., Yang, J., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Bhatt, N.S., Scheuplein, M., Rosenbaum, G.M., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Differential effects of novelty and uncertainty on exploratory choice across development. Poster spotlight at the multidisciplinary conference on Reinforcement Learning and Decision Making, Providence, RI.

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Bhatt, N.S., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Maulhardt, S., Rosenbaum, G.M., Scheuplein, M., Yang, J., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Novelty and uncertainty differentially drive exploration across development. Data blitz at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, San Francisco, CA.

Nussenbaum, K., Hamling, H., Washington, B., Velez, J.A., & Hartley, C.A. (2021). Adaptability of positive and negative learning rates across development. Symposium talk at the Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Cohen, A.O., Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D.J., Gureckis, T.M. & Hartley, C.A. (2021). Causal information-seeking strategies change across development. Symposium talk at the Society for Research in Child Development, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Valencia, D., Greer, J., Keathley, N., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Prefrontal-striatal circuitry supports adaptive memory prioritization across development. Flash talk at the Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Prefrontal-striatal circuitry supports adaptive memory prioritization across development. Talk at the Cognitive Science Society, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Cohen, A.O., Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D., Gureckis, T.M. & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Changes in causal intervention strategies across adolescence. Lightning talk at the Workshop on Curiosity, Exploration, and Explanation, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ.

Nussenbaum, K., Prentis, E., Valencia, D., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). The use of past experience to guide memory increases across development. Talk at the Manhattan Area Memory Meeting, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ.

Posters

Alvarez, L. & **Nussenbaum, K.** (2026). Disentangling the cognitive mechanisms underlying developmental changes in value generalization. Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, La Jolla, CA.

Obek, I., Fu, J., Holton, E., & Nussenbaum, K. (2026). Examining the development of goal commitment. Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, La Jolla, CA.

Chen, K. & **Nussenbaum, K.** (2026). Parallel biases in affective reactivity and learning from counterfactual feedback. Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, New York, NY.

Nussenbaum, K., & Daw, N. (2024). Good and consequential counterfactual outcomes are prioritized during learning. Society for Neuroeconomics, Cascais, Portugal.

Zhang, A., Kahn, A.E., Daw, N.D., Nussenbaum, K., & Hartley, C.A. (2025). Children leverage predictive representations for flexible, value-guided choice. Reinforcement Learning and Decision Making, Dublin, Ireland.

Nussenbaum, K., Zhang, A., Kahn, A., Daw, N., & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Children leverage predictive representations for reward-guided choice. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, Baltimore, MD.

Nussenbaum, K., & Daw, N. (2024). Individual differences in strategic exploration may reflect rational consideration of learning. Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, Boston, MA.

Hamling, H., Nussenbaum, K., Zhu, H., Kerbl, L., Washington, B.T., & Hartley, C.A. (2024). Developmental changes in the adaptation of learning computations to environmental volatility. Computational Psychiatry Conference, Minneapolis, MN.

Saragosa-Harris, N., **Nussenbaum, K.,** Hartley, C.A., & Silvers, J. (2023). The effects of novelty and uncertainty on exploratory behaviors following early life adversity. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, Santa Rosa, CA.

Lu, H.*, Katzman, P.*, **Nussenbaum, K.,** & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Sensitivity to the instrumental value of agency increases across development. Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, Oxford, UK.

Zhang, A., Nussenbaum, K., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Development of non-local learning. Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, Oxford, UK.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Reinforcement learning influences memory specificity across development. Cognitive Computational Neuroscience, Oxford, UK.

Zhang, A., Nussenbaum, K., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Development of non-local planning behavior. International Conference on Learning and Memory, Huntington Beach, CA.

Nussenbaum, K., Hamling, H.E., Zhu, H., Kerble, L., Washington, B.T., & Hartley, C.A. (2023). Sensitivity to environmental volatility during learning changes across development. International Conference on Learning and Memory, Huntington Beach, CA.

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Maulhardt, S., Yang, J., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Bhatt, N.S., Scheuplein, M., Rosenbaum, G.M., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Novelty and uncertainty differentially drive exploration across development. Society for Neuroeconomics, Crystal City, VA.

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Maulhardt, S., Yang, J., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Bhatt, N.S., Scheuplein, M., Rosenbaum, G.M., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Differential effects of novelty and uncertainty on exploratory choice across development. Conference on Reinforcement Learning and Decision Making, Providence, RI.

Nussenbaum, K., Martin, R.E., Bhatt, N.S., Bizzell-Hatcher, G., Maulhardt, S., Rosenbaum, G.M., Scheuplein, M., Yang, J., O'Doherty, J.P., Cockburn, J., & Hartley, C.A. (2022). Novelty and uncertainty differentially drive exploration across development. Cognitive Neuroscience Society, San Francisco, CA.

Scheuplein, M., **Nussenbaum, K.**, Phaneuf, C.V., Evans, M.D., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Developmental differences in model-based learning and abstract reasoning: an online replication study. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Valencia, D., Greer, J., Keathley, N., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Prefrontal-striatal circuitry supports adaptive memory prioritization across development. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Valencia, D., Greer, J., Keathley, N., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Neural mechanisms underlying the use of learned value to guide memory across development. Context and Episodic Memory Symposium, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Valencia, D., Greer, J., Keathley, N., & Hartley, C.A. (2020). Neural mechanisms underlying the use of learned value to guide memory across development. Cognitive Neuroscience Society, virtual meeting.

Nussenbaum, K., Cohen, A.O., Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D., Glover, M., Valencia, D., Shen, X., Gureckis, T.M., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Causal information-seeking strategies change through adolescence. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, New York, NY.

Cohen, A.O., **Nussenbaum, K.**, Dorfman, H., Glover, M., Valencia, D., Shen, X., Gershman, S.J., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Developmental change in the influence of causal judgments on reinforcement learning. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, New York, NY.

Nussenbaum, K., Cohen, A.O., Davis, Z.J., Halpern, D., Gureckis, T.M., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Causal intervention strategies change across adolescence. Cognitive Science Society, Montreal, Canada.

Nussenbaum, K., Cohen, A.O., Dorfman, H., Glover, M., Valencia, D., Shen, X., Gershman, S.J., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Developmental change in the use of causal inference to guide reinforcement learning. Conference on Reinforcement Learning and Decision Making, Montreal, Canada.

Cohen, A.O., **Nussenbaum, K.**, Dorfman, H., Shen, X., Sardar, H., Valencia, D., Glover, M., Gershman, S.J., & Hartley, C.A. (2019). Age-related change in the effects of causal judgments on learning from reinforcement. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, Miami, FL.

Nussenbaum, K., Prentis, E., & Hartley, C.A. (2018). Strategic encoding of useful information across development. Society for Neuroeconomics, Philadelphia, PA.

Nussenbaum, K., Prentis, E., Ocampo, J.D., & Hartley, C.A. (2018). Developmental changes in the use of environmental statistics to strategically modulate memory. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, Berlin, Germany.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2018). Developing the ability to remember information with high future reward. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, New York, NY.

Nussenbaum, K. & Hartley, C.A. (2018). Developing the ability to remember useful information. UC Irvine International Conference on Learning and Memory, Irvine, CA.

Nussenbaum, K., Nobre, A.C., & Scerif, G. (2017). Salient visual events disrupt memory-guided attention in adults but not children. Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, Portland, OR.

Nussenbaum, K., Nobre, A.C., & Scerif, G. (2017). Memories and exogenous cues interact differently across age groups to influence attentional orienting. Society for Research in Child Development, Austin, TX.

Nussenbaum, K., Myers, N., Nobre, A.C., & Scerif, G. (2016). Developmental changes in memory-guided and exogenously cued attention. Autumn School in Cognitive Neuroscience, Oxford, UK.

Nussenbaum, K., Markant, J., & Amso, D. (2016). Increasing distractor set size reduces conceptual interference during target encoding. Cognitive Neuroscience Society, New York, NY.

Nussenbaum, K. & Amso, D. (2015). An attentional Goldilocks effect for children's word-learning from digital media. Society for Research in Child Development, Philadelphia, PA.

Teaching

Instructor

Fall 2025, 2026: **PS 211**: Introduction to Experimental Design, Boston University

Guest Lecturer

Fall 2025: **PS 704**: Contemporary Trends in Psychology, Boston University
Lecture on computational cognitive development

Summer 2021: **PSYCH 34**: Developmental Psychology, New York University
Lecture on developing cognitive control

Spring 2020: **PSYCH 34**: Developmental Psychology, New York University
Lecture on memory development

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2020: **PSYCH 34**: Developmental Psychology, New York University

Spring 2015: **CLPS 0200**: Human Cognition, Brown University

Mentoring

Ph.D. Students

2025 -: **Chang Yuan (Karen) Chen**

- 2026 Clara Mayo Memorial Fellowship (BU Department of Psychological & Brain Sciences)

2025 -: **Luis Alvarez**

- 2025 Postgraduate Fellowship in Science and Humanities for Study Abroad (Mexican government)
- 2026 Ronald L. Vanden Bossche Scholarship (BU Department of Psychological & Brain Sciences)

Ph.D. Dissertation Advisory Committees

2025 -: **Michael Pascale** (BU Brain, Behavior, & Cognition; Advisor: Joe McGuire)

2025 -: **Hannah Burnell**, (BU Brain, Behavior, & Cognition; Advisor: Heidi Meyer)

MA Students

2021 - 2022: **Linda Kerbl** (MPI) → Ph.D. Student, MPI for Human Development

2018 - 2020: **Daphne Valencia** (NYU) → Research Coordinator, Mt. Sinai Hospital

Postbacc Lab Managers / Research Technicians

- 2025 -: **Ipek Obek** (BU)
- 2022 - 2024: **Alice Zhang** (NYU) → Ph.D. Student, University of Oxford
- 2021 - 2022: **Naiti Bhatt** (NYU) → Graduate Student, University of Edinburgh

Undergraduates

** indicates undergraduate research grant recipient*

- 2025 -: **Irene Zheng** (BU)
- 2025 -: **Jennifer Fu*** (BU)
• Psychology Honors Thesis
- 2020 - 2023: **Juan Velez*** (NYU)
• Collegiate Research Initiative Scholar
- 2020 - 2022: **Hannah Hamling***** (NYU) → Ph.D. Student, University of Minnesota
• Psychology Honors Thesis
• Coons/Leibowitz Research Award,
• Hillary Anne Citrin Memorial Award for Outstanding Departmental Honors Thesis
• Glushko Prize for Outstanding Honors Thesis in Minds, Brains, and Machines
- 2021 - 2022: **Haoze Zhu** (NYU Shanghai) → M.Sc. Student, Donders Institute
- 2020 - 2022: **Lia Washington**** (NYU) → MIT Research Scholars Program
• Wasserman Center Internship Grant recipient (x2)
- 2021: **Leticia Wood** (Brown University) → UX Researcher, Duolingo
• NYU Center for Neural Science REU participant
- 2019: **Michael Parola** (NYU) → J.D. Student, Georgetown
- 2019: **Nora Keathley** (Emory University) → Research Coordinator, Imagen
- 2019: **Jamie Greer** (Vassar College) → PhD Student, Harvard University
- 2018 - 2019: **Euan Prentis**** (NYU) → Ph.D. Student, University of Chicago
• Psychology Honors Thesis
• Doris Aaronson Award for Outstanding Departmental Research
- 2018: **Daryl Ocampo** (NYU) → Assistant to the Chair of Psychology, NYU

Undergraduate Thesis Committees

- 2026: **Sophia Francisco** (BU Neuroscience; Advisor: Heidi Meyer)
- 2026: **Crystal Lin** (BU Psychology; Advisor: Heidi Meyer)

Service

Ad Hoc Peer Review

Journals

October 8, 2026

<i>Cerebral Cortex</i>	<i>Molecular Psychiatry</i>
<i>Child Development</i>	<i>Nature Communications</i>
<i>Clinical Psychological Science</i>	<i>Nature Reviews Psychology</i>
<i>Cognition</i>	<i>Nature Scientific Reports</i>
<i>Cognitive, Affective, and Behavioral Neuroscience</i>	<i>Neurobiology of Aging</i>
<i>Communications Psychology</i>	<i>Neuroscience and Biobehavioral Reviews</i>
<i>Current Opinion in Behavioral Sciences</i>	<i>PLOS Biology</i>
<i>Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience</i>	<i>PLOS Computational Biology</i>
<i>Developmental Psychology</i>	<i>PLOS One</i>
<i>Developmental Review</i>	<i>Psychology of Popular Media</i>
<i>Developmental Science</i>	<i>Psychonomic Bulletin & Review</i>
<i>eLife</i>	<i>Psychological Review</i>
<i>Journal of Experimental Child Psychology</i>	<i>Science Advances</i>
<i>JEP: General</i>	<i>Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience</i>
<i>JEP: Learning, Memory, and Cognition</i>	<i>Trends in Cognitive Sciences</i>
<i>Mind, Brain, and Education</i>	

Conferences

CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (2022)
 Cognitive Computational Neuroscience (2023 - 2026)
 Cognitive Science Society (2020 - 2024)
 Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience (2023)
 Society for Research on Adolescence (2021)

Grants

American Psychological Association (Dissertation Research Award)
 National Science Foundation (Science of Learning and Augmented Intelligence Program)
 Wellcome Trust (Discovery Award Scheme)

Conference Organizing

2026: **Program Committee Member**, DevAI Workshop, *NeurIPS*, Atlanta, GA
 2018 - 2020: **Trainee Committee co-chair**, Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience
 2016 - 2017: **Speakers Committee member**, Global Scholars Symposium, Cambridge, UK
 2015 - 2016: **Logistics Committee member**, Global Scholars Symposium, Oxford, UK

Volunteer Positions

2020 - 2023: **Selector and mentor**, Brown University U.K. Scholarships Committee
 2021 - 2022: **Reviewer**, NYU Global Awards Summer Application Development Cohort
 2021 - 2022: **Student representative**, Psychology and Data Science faculty search committee, NYU
 2021: **Project reviewer**, RISE Global Scholarship
 2020: **Doctoral Admissions Working Group member**, NYU Psychology Department

2020: **Expenses and Reimbursement Working Group member**, NYU Psychology Department
2020: **Research experience leader**, NYU Psychology Department virtual summer internship
2017 - 2020: **Volunteer**, braiNY
2019 - 2020: **Social events co-chair**, Cognition & Perception Graduate Program Student Board, NYU
2017 - 2018: **Volunteer**, Scientist Action and Advocacy Network, NYU

Outreach events

2026: Guest lecture, Concord Academy neuroscience course
2024: Writing a personal statement. Lunch & learn for Princeton summer undergraduate interns
2021: What is a Ph.D.? Panel for NYU Undergraduates in Psychology
2020: Applying to the Rhodes Scholarship. Panel for Brown University undergraduates
2018: Expectations for Graduate School in STEM. Panel for NYU Undergraduates
2015: Applying for Research Fellowships. Panel for Brown University Women in Science & Engineering
2015: Applying to U.K. Fellowships. Panel for Brown University undergraduates

Other Training

2022: Kavli Summer Institute in Cognitive Neuroscience
2019: Methods in Neuroscience at Dartmouth
2018: NYU Science Communication Workshop
2016 - 2017: Oxford Center for Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging Graduate Training Programme